



SUPERIOR COURT OF SAN MATEO COUNTY

Probate - Probate

Courtroom 2C

Hearing Date: 07/22/2026 - 09:00 AM

07/13/2026

9:51 AM

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Judge: Novak, Lisa A.

Clerk: Ortega, Alexandrina

Reporter: Conde, Wendy

**IN THE SUPERIOR COURT OF THE STATE OF CALIFORNIA IN AND FOR THE COUNTY
OF SAN MATEO**

Probate

Department 13

Courtroom 2C

Hon. Lisa A. Novak

July 22, 2026 - 9:00 AM

If an appearance by Zoom is allowed, parties must appear through Zoom Video.

Zoom Audio is only to be used if Zoom Video is unavailable.

Please check in with the clerk by 8:45 AM.

Zoom Video/Audio Information	Zoom Phone-Audio Only Information Please Note: You must join by dialing in from a telephone; credentials will not work from a tablet or PC
<u>Click on this link to join the Zoom meeting (no meeting ID or passcode required):</u> Meeting ID: 161 920 9458 PASSWORD: 696850	Phone number: 1 (669) 254-5252 Meeting ID: 161 920 9458 PASSWORD: 696850

If a tentative ruling contains "APPEARANCE ORDERED", failure to appear may cause the Petition to be denied or Opposition stricken. Remote appearance is allowed BUT FOR all matters in which SIJF are sought, and where the Court has ordered an In Person appearance. Failure to appear may result in sanctions.

If a tentative ruling contains "APPEARANCE OPTIONAL", failure to appear is a waiver of oral argument and the Court may issue orders differing from the tentative ruling. Zoom is allowed for all optional appearances.

If a tentative ruling contains "NO APPEARANCE", an appearance is not required, as the matter has been pre-approved, continued, or dropped, as described.

If you wish to appear in response to the tentative ruling or in opposition to a petition, you must notify the probate clerk at dept13@sanmateocourt.org and all other parties of the intent to appear. All notifications must be completed no later than 4:00 p.m. on the court day immediately preceding the day of the hearing.



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22-PRO-00847	Estate of Barbara Dye	Continued from 02/20/2026
Line 1	Petitioner: Schmidt, Xiaping (DAYE, ROBERT E.) Decedent: Dye, Barbara Personal Representative: Schmidt, Xiaping	Petition for Final Distribution

Tentative Ruling:

APPEARANCE OPTIONAL (Zoom allowed)

First Amended Petition for Final Distribution GRANTED absent cogent objection.

24-PRO-00014	IN RE THE MATTER OF: THE ROBSON FAMILY LIVING TRUST, DATED MARCH 27, 2001, AS AMENDED AND RESTATED ON JULY 31, 2015	ANN ROBSON'S MOTION TO STRIKE IMPROPER SUBSTITUTION OF DOCUMENTS FOR EXPERT TESTIMONY
Line 2	Petitioner: CORDIS, ELIZABETH M. (GILANI, HOLLY VU, MINH HIEU) Petitioner: Peninsula Bay Trust Company (CLARK, JOHN C. BOURNE, CHRISTEN E) Petitioner: Peninsula Bay Trust Company Petitioner: Robson, John R. (GILANI, HOLLY VU, MINH HIEU) Decedent: ROBSON, ROBERT Decedent: ROBSON, SHARLEEN Objector: Cordis, Elizabeth Objector: Robson, Bradley D. (BURNSIDE, LEIGH W.) Objector: Robson, John R. Beneficiary: Robson, Ann (STREIFF, ZACHARY ALAN)	Motion to Strike

Tentative Ruling:

NO APPEARANCE

Ann Robson's Motion to Strike Improper Substitution of Documents for Expert Testimony is DENIED as moot given that the Statement of Decision was filed and issued on April 3, 2025. Moreover, Ann Robson's request for dismissal of all petitions and objections was granted June 3, 2026



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24-PRO-01396	IN RE THE IAM TRUST DATED JULY 31, 2020	RE: Discovery and New Filing - Continued on 03/20/2026 Petition to Remove Jie Gao Yu as Co-Trustee of the Iam Trust and to Recover Trust assets - Continued on 03/20/2026 TRUSTEE'S NOTICE OF MOTION AND MOTION TO COMPEL EDWARD MAK'S COMPLIANCE WITH DEPOSITION SUBPOENA FOR THE PRODUCTION OF BUSINESS RECORDS; REQUEST FOR SANCTIONS; MEMORANDUM OF POINTS AND AUTHORITIES; DECLARATION OF KENDAL E. FLETCHER
Line 3, 4, 5	Petitioner: YU, JIE GAO (BRACCINI, STEVEN P. FLETCHER, KENDAL E.) Trustor: The IAM TRUST dated July 31, 2020 Objector: YU, HUANGBO (LOEW, JEFFREY R.) Guardian Ad Litem: NGUYEN, JULIETTE D.	Status Hearing Status Hearing Motion to Compel

Tentative Ruling:

APPEARANCE OPTIONAL

The proofs of service filed on 3/9/2026 and 6/2/2026 regarding service of the Notice of Motion and Motion to Compel Edward Mak's Compliance with Deposition Subpoena and Amended Notice of Motion do not include Edward Mak and do not state that counsel listed on those proofs of service represents (or represented) Edward Mak.

Therefore, *Trustee Jie Gao Yu's Motion to Compel Edward Mak's Compliance with Deposition Subpoena for the Production of Business Records; Request for Sanctions* is CONTINUED to November 24, 2026 at 9:00 am for Jie Gao Tu to either file amended proofs of service clarifying which counsel represents (or represented) Edward Mak or file a new proof of service showing that Edward Mak was properly served.



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The Court on its own motion, pursuant to CCP § 639(a)(5), appoints a discovery referee to hear and determine any and all discovery motions and disputes relevant to discovery in this action between Jie Gao Yu and Huangbo Yu, including, but not limited to *Trustee Jie Gao Yu's Motion to Compel Huangbo Yu's Compliance and Further Responses to Requests for Production of Documents, Special Interrogatories, Form Interrogatories, Requests for Admission, and Production of Privilege Log* filed on 2/9/2026, and to report findings and make a recommendation thereon. The referee is authorized to set the date, time, and place for all hearings determined by the referee to be necessary; direct the issuance of subpoenas; preside over hearings; take evidence; and rule on objections, motions, and other requests made during the course of the hearing. The Court finds that exceptional circumstances exist in this action requiring the appointment of a discovery referee because the parties have filed a continuum of discovery motions, the discovery is voluminous and highly contentious, and the number of documents to be reviewed makes the inquiry inordinately time-consuming for the Court's calendar.

The parties are ordered to meet and confer within fifteen (15) days to decide on a referee and file a report with the name of the agreed-upon referee. If the parties cannot decide on a referee, each party shall submit to the court up to three nominees for appointment as referee within thirty (30) days, objections to any referees shall be filed within forty-five (45) days, and the Court shall then appoint one referee from among the nominees against whom there is no legal objection at the next hearing on November 24, 2026 at 9:00 am.

Co-Trustee Jie Gao Yu's Petition for Removal of Huangbo Yu and Petition to Remove Jie Gao Yu as Co-Trustee are CONTINUED to November 24, 2026 at 9:00 am for status. Parties are ordered to file status reports ten (10) days before the next hearing.

25-PRO-01364	ESTATE OF CHRISTINE MAE BARSİ	Continued on 02/20/2026
Line 6	Petitioner: BARSİ, DAVID ANTHONY (PAOLINI-MORI, ANNE MARIE) Decedent: BARSİ, CHRISTINE MAE	Spousal/Domestic Partner Property Petition

Tentative Ruling:

APPEARANCE OPTIONAL

Spousal Property Petition is GRANTED absent cogent objection.



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25-PRO-01723	ESTATE OF DELMY JOSEFINA HINDS	Continued on 02/20/2026
Line 7	Petitioner: SANCHEZ, CARLOS ERNESTO (Pro Se) Decedent: HINDS, DELMY JOSEFINA	Petition to Determine Succession to Real Property

Tentative Ruling:

APPEARANCE OPTIONAL

The Petition to Determine Succession to Real Property is DENIED without prejudice due to the following:

- Failure to comply with Probate Code 13151 and 13152.
- No proof of service filed.
- No proposed order is filed.
- The petition is missing the following information:
 - #2(a), the date of death is missing.
 - #3, the box showing that at least 40 days have passed since decedent's death is not checked as required by Probate Code 13151(a).
 - At #6, neither box is checked.
 - No attachment 8 is included as required at #8. Note that an inventory and appraisal is require to be included in Attachment 8. Also see the requirement for a probate referee to be appointed to appraise all real property and personal property other than cash or its equivalent.
 - #9(b), neither box is checked.
 - No Attachment 11 is included as required at #11.
 - #13 is blank.
 - No attachment 14 is included as required at #14.

At the last court hearing on 2/20/2026 the Court granted a continuance to allow petitioner to address all of these issues. Nothing has been filed since that date.

26-PRO-00163	Guardianship of FNU Bikramjit Singh	
Line 8, 9	Petitioner: Kaur, Kulwant (VIRDI, NARESHWAR) Ward: Bikramjit Singh, FNU Proposed Guardian: Kaur, Kulwant	Appointment of Guardian for Person of the Minor Petition for Special Immigrant Juvenile Findings



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Tentative Ruling:

APPEARANCE OPTIONAL (Zoom not allowed)

The declaration in support of the petition for SIJF is insufficient, in that it appears to be a single statement, written in the third person, yet verified by both the minor and proposed guardian. The matter will be continued for the minor to submit his own declaration which spells out in detail his home life before coming to the United States, as well as any and all contact or communication with his parents since his arrival. He shall include whether he has ever provided his parents with a phone number by which they could contact him, whether he has provided them any information so that they could communicate with him electronically or on social media, and whether or not he has provided them his current address. The next hearing is October 5, 2026 at 9:00 a.m.

26-PRO-00194	In Re the Matter of the Collins/Steinfist Family Trust, dated November 10, 2005.	PETITION TO ESTABLISH TRUST INTEREST OVER PERSONAL PROPERTY
Line 10	Petitioner: Howard, Julia (SEKSARIA, JENNIFER P.) Petitioner: Zaretsky, Michael (SEKSARIA, JENNIFER P.) Decedent: COLLINS, SHARON Decedent: STEINFIST, JOHN F.	Petition Hearing

Tentative Ruling:

APPEARANCE OPTIONAL

Amended Petition (1) to Establish Trust Interest Over Personal Property; and (2) for Instructions is GRANTED absent cogent objection.

26-PRO-00197	IN THE MATTER OF THE ESTATE OF BRUCE HEGEDUS	PETITION FOR ORDER TO PRODUCE WILL AND DAMAGES; PROPOSED ORDER.
Line 11	Petitioner: Mollica, Christine (MENDELMAN, JEFFREY) Decedent: HEGEDUS, BRUCE	Petition Hearing



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Tentative Ruling:

APPEARANCE OPTIONAL

Decedent died December 20, 2025. This Petition for Order to Produce Will and Damages was filed February 13, 2026, alleging that decedent's spouse, the purported custodian of his will, had not lodged it within the statutory 30-day time frame. That date would have been January 20, 2025. The will was lodged April 7, 2026. As such, any request in the petition to order decedent's spouse to produce the will is moot. Acting as a court of equity, the Court can certainly understand why a spouse, who just lost her husband, might not file his will within 30 days of his death, what with all of the other priorities as well as emotional impact taking priority.

Petitioner seeks damages, but that request is unsupported by billing records and the Attachment A referenced in the supplemental filed July 15, 2026. The Court is not inclined to grant any alleged damages as it has not been proven that petitioner suffered any damages in the short period of time from January 20th until April 7th.

However, if petitioner still seeks monetary damages, the matter is CONTINUED to November 10, 2026 at 9:00 am for Petitioner to file and serve Exhibit A that appears to be missing from her Declaration filed on 7/15/2026, and for Petitioner to file billing records and receipts for the damages she is requesting. The Petitioner should attach a copy of the trust of Eleanor Falstrom for which petitioner is the trustee. If any damages are awarded, they will not include any fees following the lodging of the will.

26-PRO-00198	The Purported 2000 James W. Norman and Mabel Kay Norman Revocable	The Petition seeks the following relief pursuant to Probate Code sections 850, 859, 17200, 17206, and 17211:
Line 12	Petitioner: Jones, LaVerne Norman (Pro Se) Respondent: Norman, Mabel Kay	Petition Hearing

Tentative Ruling:

NO APPEARANCE (Zoom allowed)

Petition is CONTINUED to November 13, 2026 at 9:00 am for Petitioner to file a proof of service/notice of hearing that complies with Probate Code 851(a) and (c). Specifically, DE-115 should be used, not DE-120, 30 days notice must be given, a copy of the petition and any supplemental documentation thereto must be served, and the notice of hearing must include the required language contained in PC 851(c). The defective proof of service filed also does not list the Respondent, and names an attorney, but no information as to whom that attorney represents. Petitioner filed her initial pleading on 2/13/2026, and then filed what she labeled as "Memorandum



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of Points and Authorities" and a Declaration on 7/06/2026. All parts of her petition must be served. No valid proof of service is on file for any of these documents.

26-PRO-00271	IN RE THE THOMAS F. MANDERS, JR., REVOCABLE TRUST, DATED APRIL 10, 2015	PETITION TO RECOVER TRUST PROPERTY AND MEMORANDUM OF POINTS AND AUTHORITIES IN SUPPORT THEREOF
Line 13	Petitioner: TORRES, HEATHER F. (ZELL, DENNIS S.) Decedent: MANDERS, JAN B Decedent: MANDERS, THOMAS F	Petition Hearing

Tentative Ruling:

APPEARANCE ORDERED

Petition to Recover Trust Property is silent as to why San Mateo County is the proper venue. The court has reviewed documents including the death certificate of Thomas Manders Jr, which shows that he resided in San Mateo County at the time of his death, as did petitioner herein. The Court also reviewed the Trust, which was executed by both the decedent and the petitioner in Burlingame California, which is also in San Mateo County. As such, the Court can infer that venue is proper, but petitioner must affirmatively allege that the Trust is being administered in San Mateo County. That may be done by submitting a declaration at the time of hearing. The Petition also doesn't include any prayer for relief, but the Court has reviewed the proposed order filed July 13, 2026. Petitioner to appear and confirm accuracy of proposed order. Counsel is reminded that both of these issue are required to be set forth in the petition itself.

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26-PRO-00277	IN THE MATTER OF THE OLIVIA PRIMUS 1991 TRUST	PETITION FOR APPROVAL OF CREDITOR CLAIM AGAINST TRUST
Line 14	Petitioner: PRIMUS, VALERIE L (Pro Se) Decedent: PRIMUS, OLIVIA	Petition Hearing

Tentative Ruling:**APPEARANCE OPTIONAL**

Petition for Approval of Creditor Claim Against Trust is CONTINUED to December 15, 2026 at 9:00 am for Petitioner to address the following issues:

- Basis for venue in San Mateo County is not provided;
- No legal authority is provided;
- Petition is not verified as required by CRC 7.103(b);
- No billing records are provided and there is insufficient support provided for the caregiving fees requested;
- No copy of the Trust is provided;
- No proof of service is filed giving notice to the Trust beneficiaries;
- It is unclear how the rate of \$50/hour was agreed upon between Petitioner and Decedent;
- No receipts are provided for the expenses advanced and paid of which Petitioner seeks reimbursement; and
- No proposed order is filed.

26-PRO-00398	LAUREN CREEVY LOVE SPECIAL NEEDS TRUST	Re: Potential Filing of a Petition for Instructions
Line 15	Petitioner: LOVE, LAUREN CREEVY (Pro Se) Petitioner: San Mateo County Public Guardian (SAN MATEO COUNTY ATTORNEY'S OFFICE) Petitioner: SAN MATEO COUNTY PUBLIC GUARDIAN	Status Hearing

Tentative Ruling:**APPEARANCE OPTIONAL**

The Petition is GRANTED-IN PART and DENIED-IN-PART as follows: Due to the vacancy of the Trustee of The Lauren Creevy Love Irrevocable Trust ("Love SNT"), the Court appoints the Public Guardian as the Successor Trustee of the Love SNT. The Public Guardian, as the Successor Trustee of the Love SNT has only the authority set forth in the terms of the Love SNT. The Public Guardian as Trustee of the Love SNT has sole and absolute discretion to determine whether distributions should be made for Ms. Love's supplemental needs and quality of life, consistent with the Love SNT's purpose of preserving eligibility for public benefits such as SSI and Medi-Cal. The



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Court finds that the overall purpose of the Love SNT is to supplement, rather than replace, government benefits, thereby enhancing Ms. Love's quality of life while maintaining eligibility for public assistance programs. The remainder of the Petition is DENIED. The Petition set for hearing on August 31, 2025 is DENIED as moot in light of this order, and the hearing is vacated.

PRO078000	CONSERVATORSHIP OF MARY ELIZABETH KOTT	
Line 16	Petitioner: KOTT, GERALDINE (Pro Se) Conservatee: KOTT, MARY ELIZABETH Conservator: KOTT, KAREN M. (Pro Se) Conservator: KOTT, MARK A. (Pro Se) Brother: KOTT, MARK A. (Pro Se) Sister: KOTT, KAREN M. (Pro Se)	Conservatorship Review - Biennial
Tentative Ruling: NO APPEARANCE The conservatorship shall continue and be reviewed in two (2) years. The request to waive the account is approved. The assessment amount of \$850.00 for the cost of the Court's investigation is ordered and deferred until the Court determines sufficient funds exist.		

PRO098778	CONSERVATORSHIP OF MANUEL J. ORTIZ	* on 1/30/2026 Hearing Type changed from CRAB to CRB SIXTEENTH ACCOUNT AND REPORT OF CONSERVATOR AND PETITION FOR SETTLEMENT OF ACCOUNT AND ATTORNEYS' FEES
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Line 17, 18

Conservatee: ORTIZ, MANUEL J
Conservator: HERNANDEZ, ALAN C (DURRANS, KATHLEEN A. CAMPOBELLO, CARLO)
Conservator: HERNANDEZ, ALBA N (DURRANS, KATHLEEN A. CAMPOBELLO, CARLO)
Brother: ORTIZ, MARCUS (Pro Se)
Child: ORTIZ, MANUEL, JR (Pro Se)
Father: ORTIZ, ELOY C. (Pro Se)
Payor: Payor

Conservatorship Review -
Biennial

Petition Hearing

Tentative Ruling:

NO APPEARANCE

Conservatorship shall continue and be reviewed in two (2) years. Bond is fixed at \$805,000. The Sixteenth Account and Report of Conservator and Petition for Settlement of Account and for Attorneys' Fees is GRANTED. The fees requested by counsel for the conservators are granted in the amount requested. The assessment amount of \$850.00 for the cost of this investigation is ordered to be paid from the conservatorship estate to the Superior Court of California, County of San Mateo, within fifteen (15) days. The Court orders payment of \$850 for the assessment of the 2024 conservatorship review to be paid from the conservatorship estate to the Superior Court of California, County of San Mateo, within fifteen (15) days.

Hearings Total: 18